UNIVERSITY OF Baguio
SCHOOL OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT (GDD)

Fowl Play

VERSION NO. 3

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I. GAME OVERVIEW

1.1 High Concept Statement

In *Fowl Play*, one friend signs what he thinks is a free wings-for-life deal at a chicken-themed casino — but the contract's fine print binds anyone who eats the wings too, so sharing them with his three friends drags them all in without any of them signing a thing. Now bound to The House's endless "loyalty" contract, the four of them must gamble their way to enough winnings to void the cursed contract before The House claims them for good.

1.2 Elevator Pitch

Fowl Play is a first-person party game for four players who share one bank account and one very bad contract. One of you signed what looked like a free wings-for-life deal at a chicken-themed casino called The House — except the fine print means anyone who *eats* the wings is bound to the contract too, so sharing them with your friends dragged all four of you in without the rest of you ever signing anything. Now you've got a handful of in-game days to gamble your way to enough winnings to void the contract before it claims you for good. The catch: every bet comes out of the same shared wallet, so when a friend starts pushing their luck too far, you can grab them, punch them into a stunned heap, or drag them bodily away from the table — at your own risk, since hitting a friend costs the entire team too. It's built for small groups who want a short, loud, chaotic multiplayer session full of betrayal, bad decisions, and yelling at your friends to stop gambling.

1.3 Genre, Platform, and Target Audience

Genre and sub-genre	First-person co-op party game / "chaos casino" sub-genre — social sabotage mechanics layered over casino minigames.
Genre conventions the game keeps	Short, replayable sessions; simple, immediately-readable controls; humor-forward tone; designed to be funnier with more people watching/reacting.
Genre conventions the game breaks	Most party-chaos games (Overcooked, Fall Guys, GWYF itself) use top-down or third-person cameras specifically because they're easier to keep readable with physical chaos — *Fowl Play* uses first-person instead, betting that per-player screens and grounded, at-the-table minigames create more tension than the usual wide, cartoonish view. It also breaks from typical party games by giving its minigames real decision depth (press-your-luck calls in blackjack/roulette/poker) instead of simplified abstracted mechanics.
Target platform	PC (Windows), LAN-based local multiplayer — keyboard and mouse

Target audience	Small friend groups, late teens to mid-20s, comfortable with basic first-person movement controls, looking for a short, social, chaotic party session rather than a long-form single-player experience.
Expected session length	One full run (survive 10 days) is roughly 40–55 minutes, designed to be replayed multiple times in one sitting with the same group.

1.4 Scope and Feasibility Statement

In scope for this term	LAN-based local multiplayer for up to 4 players, one host; first-person per-player cameras; one chicken-themed casino room with an integrated break/safe corner; 5 minigames (blackjack, roulette, a simplified poker-flavored game, a mines-style egg-and-bomb game, and a chicken-crossing crash game); shared wallet with real-time visual feedback; hit → stun → carry → throw sabotage mechanic (simplified state-machine, not physics-based ragdoll); grab/drag-to-safe-zone; day-based structure with a 5-minute timer per day, daily quota, and a rotating minigame pool; 1 extra life (when quota is missed, the wallet is reset to half of its balance at the start of that day); the Watched Player system with its 2 core effects (Blessed/Cursed); host-authoritative physics sync and basic movement interpolation for multiplayer; the contract/wings intro as narrative flavor.
Out of scope (deliberately cut)	True internet-facing online multiplayer (LAN only); proximity voice chat; full Texas Hold'em-style poker with real hand-ranking and betting rounds; multiple rooms or floors; true joint-based ragdoll physics; the 6-item stretch system; the hidden cumulative-earnings alt-ending; additional Watched effects beyond the core 2; character customization/emotes; detailed or fully animated character models

Feasibility justification	With a 5-person team and only one confirmed synchronous block (Tuesday lab, 11 AM–2 PM) where all members can physically test LAN multiplayer together, the scope above was built around that constraint specifically: core networking and physics-sync work is front-loaded into early Tuesday sessions, since that is the only reliable window to verify host/join behavior and knockback sync across multiple real devices. Wednesday's half-day in the afternoon and Friday's fully online day support solo or pair work — asset creation, minigame logic, and UI that don't require the whole team in the same room — while Saturday is treated as a flexible group work day for integration and playtesting once individual pieces are ready. This rhythm is why the scope favors *one* system done well over several done partially: a single room, five focused minigames, and a simplified stun/carry mechanic are all achievable inside roughly one lab session a week plus asynchronous solo work. A more ambitious version of this concept — a larger minigame roster, multiple rooms or floors, true physics-based ragdoll simulation, or genuine internet-facing netcode — would each demand far more synchronized team time than this schedule realistically allows, which is why they're logged as out of scope or stretch goals rather than committed features.

II. FORMAL ELEMENTS

Players	4 players, local co-op (not competitive) — everyone works toward the same shared goal, though individual choices (greedy bets, risky pushes) can work against the group even without anyone intending to "win" against a teammate.
Objectives	Win condition: survive the full run (meet each day's quota, across a set number of days) without failing quota twice, ultimately voiding the contract. Immediate objective each day: hit that day's quota before the 5-minute timer runs out.
Rules	The wallet is shared — all winnings and losses apply to one pool, not individual accounts. Only one player may occupy a minigame table at a time. Any player may hit any other player at any time, with no cooldown or restriction — but every hit shakes a small amount of money loose from the target, drawn from the shared wallet, so hitting always carries a collective cost even though it's freely repeatable. The stunned state is a scripted limp pose, not a simulated ragdoll: a stunned player's body acts as a single object that teammates can carry, drop, or throw. To end the day, all 4 players must be standing together inside a marked exit zone at the same time; reaching it is the only way to manually close out a day.
Procedures	Each day in order: (1) The House announces the day's quota and reveals which minigames are open and who is Watched (Blessed/Cursed); (2) Players freely move around the room, choosing which table to approach; (3) At a table, a player places a bet and is given a press-your-luck decision (cash out or push further); (4) At any point, other players may hit a teammate to stun them (small wallet cost per hit), and a stunned player can be picked up and carried — while carried, they cannot wake or act until dropped or thrown; (5) The day ends the moment either condition is met: quota is reached and the timer naturally expires, or quota is reached and all 4 players gather together in the exit zone before time runs out (an optional early end). (6) If quota is not met at day's end, the extra-life penalty triggers instead of ending the run (unless the extra life is already spent).

Resources	The shared wallet (spent on bets, earned from wins, drained in small amounts by hits, cut in half as a penalty if a day's quota isn't met); the extra life itself — not a refill, but a one-time pass that lets the run continue past a single failed day, spent the first time quota isn't met; time (the 5-minute daily countdown); a teammate's stunned/carried state, functional as a resource in the sense that it can be "spent" to forcibly remove someone from play for a stretch of time.
Conflict	The escalating daily quota under time pressure; the tension between an individual player's temptation to keep pushing a bet and the group's collective risk; the Watched player's altered risk/reward that day; the fact that stopping a friend costs the entire team something too, so there's no purely safe way to intervene.
Boundaries	Physically, the game is confined to a single casino room (including its integrated break/safe corner) — there is no other space to go. Conceptually, play is bounded by the day structure: nothing carries over within a day except what's tracked (wallet, lives), and each day is a fresh, time-limited attempt bounded by that day's specific quota and rotation of open games.
Outcome	Win: quota is met — either by the timer expiring with quota already hit, or earlier if all 4 players gather in the exit zone once quota is reached — advancing to the next day. Penalty: the timer expires without quota met, and the extra life hasn't been used yet. The extra life is spent, the wallet is reset to half of the balance the team started that day with, and the run continues into the next day at its higher quota. Whatever the team won or lost during the failed day is discarded, so the penalty does not depend on how close the team came. Loss: the timer expires without quota met, and the extra life was already used — contract remains, run ends regardless of how much money is left in the wallet.

III. MDA AND PLAYER EXPERIENCE

3.1 Mechanics, Dynamics, and Aesthetics

Mechanic (as authored)	Dynamic it is expected to produce	Aesthetic / kind of fun it serves
Single shared wallet across all players	Players self-police each other's bets in real time; anxiety spikes whenever anyone else is gambling, not just yourself	Fellowship (shared stakes) turning into Challenge (managing a resource you don't fully control)
Press-your-luck decision inside each minigame (cash out vs. push)	Escalating suspense at the table, amplified by teammates watching and reacting out loud	Challenge (risk/reward tension) and Fantasy (the thrill of "one more bet")
Watched Blessed/Cursed status, re-rolled and announced daily	Group strategy shifts day to day around protecting or exploiting whoever's flagged	Discovery (each day plays differently) and Fellowship (coordinated group response)
Free, spammable hit-to-stun (no cooldown), each hit shakes a small amount of money loose from the target's shared wallet	Players hit each other constantly for fun, but self-regulate as a group once the wallet visibly shrinks from overuse — chaos has a shared, not individual, cost	Sensation (spammable slapstick) balanced against Challenge (the group collectively feels the cost)
Carry-lock: a stunned player can only wake when dropped or thrown, not while held	Teammates physically drag a stubborn or tilted gambler toward the exit against their will; genuine tug-of-war if that player fights to get back to a table	Fellowship (forcing the group toward a shared goal) and Sensation (comedic struggle/chase)

Mechanic (as authored)	Dynamic it is expected to produce	Aesthetic / kind of fun it serves
Exit zone: all 4 players must stand together in a marked area to manually end the day	The day's ending becomes a coordination event, not a menu action — someone's always missing, stuck at a table, or being dragged in late	Challenge (last-second coordination) and Fellowship (a shared "we made it" moment)
Failing quota halves the shared wallet and spends the team's one extra life	Players grow visibly more risk-averse and coordinated once the extra life is gone, since the next failure ends the run outright	Challenge (rising stakes-awareness as the safety net disappears)
Randomized daily rotation of which minigames are open	Players adjust strategy day to day rather than falling into a fixed routine; scouting the room becomes a small ritual at the start of each day	Discovery (variety keeps each day feeling distinct)

3.2 Targeted Kinds of Fun

Fowl Play primarily targets **Fellowship** and **Challenge.** Fellowship comes from the shared wallet and the physical sabotage mechanics — nearly everything a player does is legible to and affects their friends, and the best moments (a desperate tackle, a shared "no, don't push it" groan) only exist because other people are in the room. Challenge comes from the press-your-luck decisions inside each minigame and the daily quota under time pressure, which stay meaningful because failure has a real, visible cost to the whole group, not just the individual gambling.

A secondary target is **Sensation** — the physical comedy of the hit/stun/carry mechanic is a deliberate source of fun independent of the gambling systems, giving the game a moment-to-moment kinetic quality rather than being purely a decision-making game.

Deliberately not pursued: **Narrative.** The contract/wings premise exists as comedic flavor and a framing device, not a story the player is meant to follow closely or feel emotionally invested in beyond the opening joke. Given the term's scope and a 5-person team's available hours, depth was intentionally spent on the social/physical systems

(Fellowship, Challenge, Sensation) rather than on branching story content, dialogue, or character writing — a trade-off that fits a short, replayable party format better than a narrative-driven one would.

3.3 Player Types and Motivation

Fowl Play is designed primarily around **Bartle's Socializer** type, with a deliberate secondary appeal to **Killer**-type impulses inside a cooperative frame. Socializers are served directly by the shared wallet (every decision is inherently social) and by the Watched system (which gives the group something new to talk about and react to every day). The hit mechanic, meanwhile, offers a controlled outlet for Killer-style impulses — knocking a friend around is unrestricted and spammable, which serves pure physical-comedy appeal — without the game becoming genuinely competitive, since every hit drains the *shared* wallet rather than costing the hitter personally. This keeps the Killer-adjacent action self-limiting at the group level: the fun of spamming hits is real, but a team that overdoes it visibly erodes its own shared resource, which naturally pulls the behavior back toward Fellowship-driven cooperation rather than needing an individual penalty to enforce restraint.

3.4 Player Experience (PX) Goals

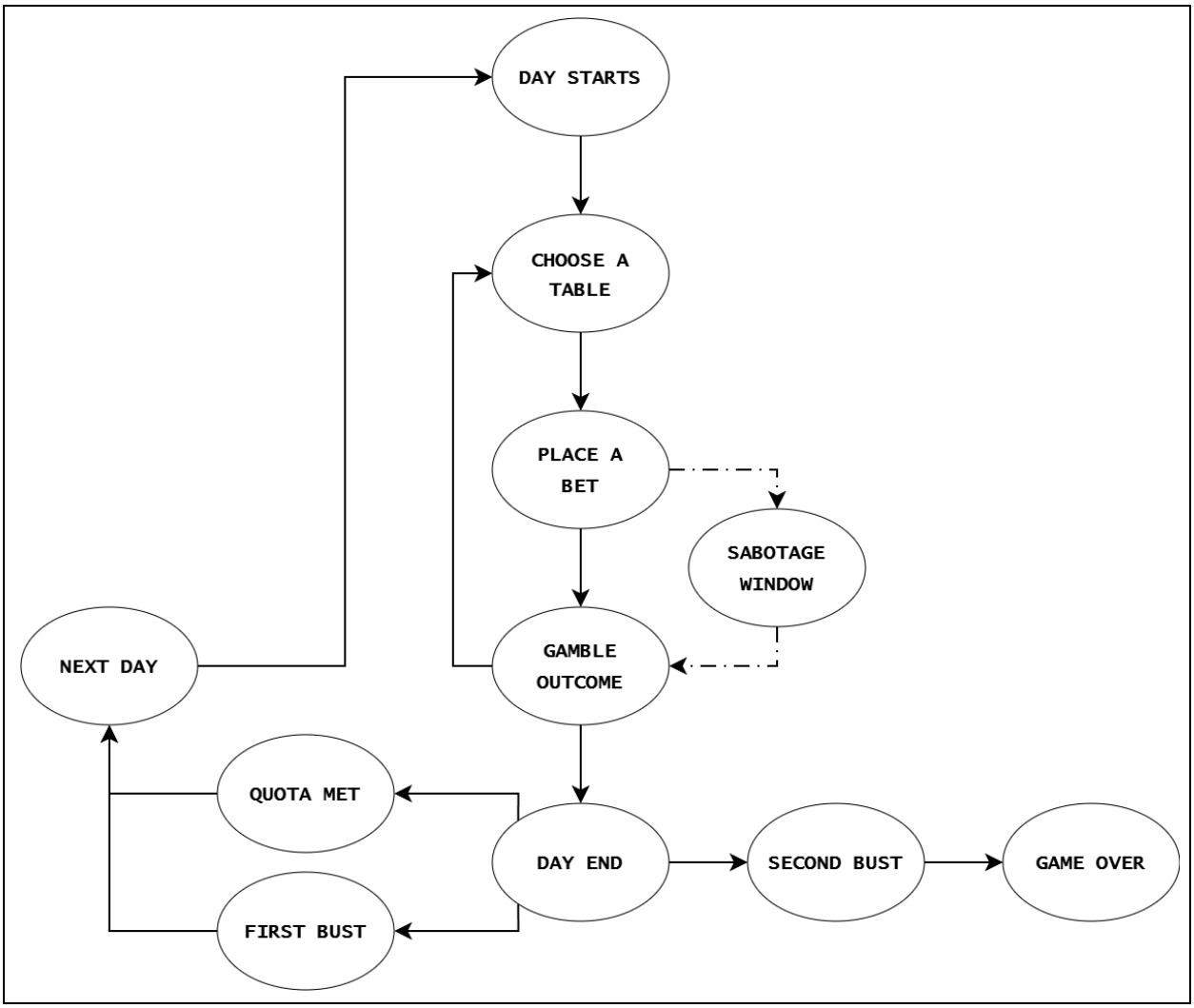
PX goal (what the player should feel, and when)	Design feature intended to produce it	How you would observe it in a playtest
A jolt of panic when a teammate's bet is climbing dangerously high	Real-time wallet feedback (shake/flash) plus an escalating audio cue tied to bet size	Players lean toward the screen, reach for movement input, or verbally call out ("stop, stop, STOP") without being prompted

PX goal (what the player should feel, and when)	Design feature intended to produce it	How you would observe it in a playtest
Mischievous triumph after successfully tackling a friend away from a table just in time	The hit/stun mechanic's impact feedback (knockback force, sound, brief slow-down) paired with the carry-to-safety follow-up	Laughter or cheering in the moment; players asking to replay that day or bragging about the tackle afterward
Relief and satisfaction when the whole team finally makes it into the exit zone together after a chaotic day	The exit zone requires all 4 players physically present at once — a visible, shared "we made it" moment rather than a menu confirmation	Players physically rush/sprint toward the zone together near time's end; audible celebration or a shared exhale when the day closes
A sinking "oh no, here we go again" feeling the moment quota isn't met and the extra-life penalty kicks in	A distinct visual/audio cue from The House when the extra life is triggered, paired with a visibly harsher tone (lighting shift, quota increase) for the final life	Players go quiet or visibly tense up when the penalty triggers; more cautious, coordinated play afterward compared to earlier in the day
A rush of temptation at the exact moment a minigame offers "cash out or push further"	The press-your-luck prompt itself — framed to visually emphasize what's already been won vs. what's still on the table	Players hesitate, verbally think out loud ("should I—"), or get audibly egged on / warned by teammates watching nearby

PX goal (what the player should feel, and when)	Design feature intended to produce it	How you would observe it in a playtest
Curiosity and light anticipation at the start of each day, wondering which games rotated in	The randomized daily minigame pool, revealed at day-start alongside the quota	Players actively scan/comment on which tables are open before deciding where to go, rather than heading straight to a fixed table out of habit
Comic indignation or mock-betrayal at being knocked down and dragged away by a teammate mid-bet	The hit-to-stun and carry-lock mechanics, paired with the carried player retaining look/camera control so they can visibly react	Player laughs, protests out loud, or exaggeratedly struggles/complains while being carried, rather than staying silent
A deflating, almost funny sense of doom when quota isn't met a second time, with no extra life left, and the run actually ends	A distinct "final loss" sting from The House — heavier and more final than the extra-life penalty cue — paired with a visual shift in the room (lights fully cutting, machines going dark, The House's "voice" delivering a closing line)	Players react audibly (groaning, laughing at the absurdity, blaming each other) rather than going silent; players immediately ask to restart rather than feeling like the session is truly "over"

IV. CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

4.1 Core Loop Diagram



4.2 Loop Walkthrough

A single pass through the loop starts the moment a new day opens: The House announces the quota, reveals which of the five minigames are active that day, and names who's Watched — Blessed and Cursed. From there, players scatter to the tables that look worth the risk. One player sits down and places a bet; the game offers a choice to cash out or push for more, and as the bet climbs, the wallet visibly reacts, pulling the other three players' attention whether they want it or not. If someone decides the bet has gone too far, they can rush over and hit the gambler — a free, spammable action that shakes a small amount of money out of the shared wallet — stunning them, then pick them up and carry them away; once carried, the stunned player can't act again until they're dropped or thrown. This sabotage loop can happen to anyone, at any table, at any moment, and often overlaps with two or three other bets happening at once elsewhere in the room. This continues — bet, react, maybe sabotage, repeat — until either the quota is hit and the timer runs out naturally, the team chooses to gather early at the exit zone once quota's already met, or the timer runs out with quota unmet, triggering the extra-life penalty

for one harder, tenser final attempt. One full pass, start to day-end, is expected to take close to the full 5-minute timer on most days, since the loop is designed to be re-entered many times within a single day rather than resolved in one bet.

4.3 Macro and Micro Loops

Micro loop	Choose a Table → Place a Bet → Gamble Outcome → back to Choose a Table. This repeats continuously within a single day, and can be interrupted at any point by the Sabotage Window — any player can hit another mid-bet, stunning and potentially carrying them off, without ending the loop itself.
Macro loop	Day Starts → the micro loop repeats until Day End → branches to Quota Met, First Bust, or Second Bust → Quota Met and First Bust both route into Next Day, which loops back to Day Starts for a fresh, harder day. Second Bust is the one path that breaks the macro loop entirely, ending the run at Game Over.
Relationship between them	Every outcome inside the micro loop (a win, a loss, a successful sabotage) feeds the same shared wallet the macro loop is tracking — there's no separate currency or unlock system bridging the two. The macro loop doesn't change what the micro loop *is*; it only raises what the micro loop has to survive, since each new day tightens the quota and re-rolls who's Watched. So the moment-to-moment gameplay a player is doing on Day 4 is mechanically identical to Day 1 — what's different is how much margin for error they have left.

4.4 In-Game and Out-Game Actions

In-game actions	Moving through the casino room; sitting at a table and placing a bet; making the cash-out-or-push decision inside a minigame; hitting a teammate to stun them; picking up, carrying, and dropping/throwing a stunned teammate; gathering together at the exit zone to end a day early once quota is met; reacting to The House's day-start announcements (quota, minigame rotation, Watched status) and day-end outcome (success, penalty, or Game Over).

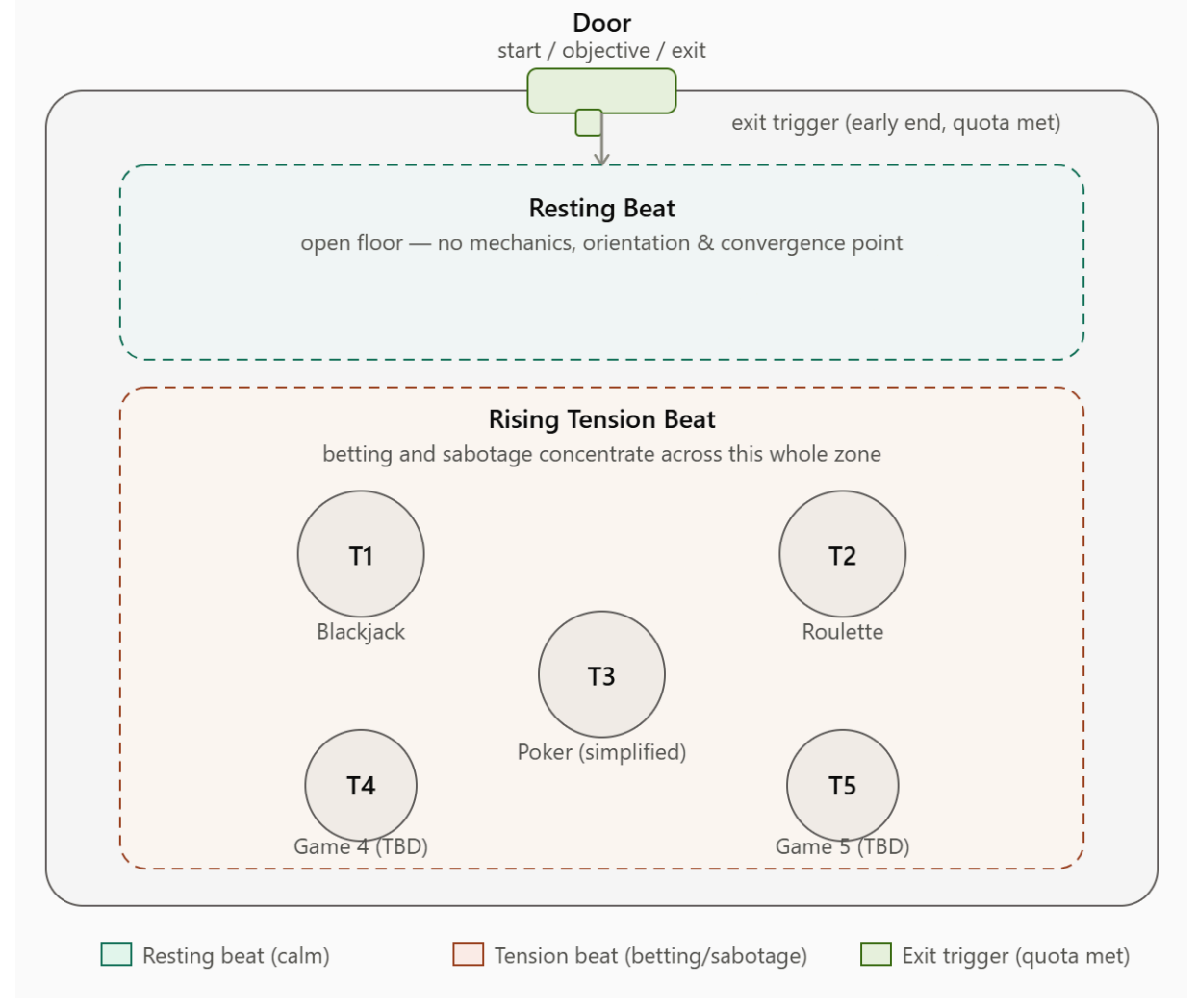
Out-game actions	Hosting or joining a LAN session before a run begins, via the lobby/connect screen. Beyond that, there are no menus, upgrades, or shop screens between days — this is a deliberate design choice, not an omission: every system that would normally live in an out-game menu (wallet total, extra-life status, Watched rotation, rising quota) instead persists and escalates automatically inside the run itself, so the tension of the macro loop is never interrupted by stepping outside the fiction into a UI screen .

V. LEVEL DESIGN

5.1 Level Layout Pattern

Fowl Play's casino floor uses an **open layout** — a single room with no interior walls, corridors, or sightline-blocking geometry, all five tables and the exit door visible and reachable from anywhere in the space. This is a direct consequence of the core gameplay loop: players need to notice a teammate's bet escalating from across the room (the shared-wallet panic response is the core tension driver), and the daily minigame rotation needs to be scoutable at a glance the moment a day starts. A linear or hub-and-spoke layout would force players through fixed paths or sightline-limited spokes, which would mute both of those — an open floor lets risk be read purely through distance and visibility rather than through forced structure, which fits a game whose central mechanic is social awareness of what your friends are doing right now.

5.2 Annotated Level Map



5.3 Pacing and Difficulty Curve

Within a single day, difficulty isn't driven by where a player is standing — it's driven by the relationship between the 5-minute timer and quota progress. Early in a day, with time to spare, any bet feels low-stakes; the same bet with the timer nearly out and quota still unmet becomes the day's most tense moment, regardless of which table it happens at.

The **flow-channel fit point** sits in the day's middle stretch — enough time has passed that the player has real information (how close is quota, is anyone Watched, how much is banked) to make a deliberate risk read, without the final-seconds panic overriding judgment. This is where the press-your-luck decision is meant to feel like genuine skill rather than a blind gamble or a trivial non-choice.

The **boredom risk** sits at the very start of a day — a full 5 minutes with no pressure yet can make early bets feel inconsequential. This is mitigated by the Watched (Blessed/Cursed) announcement firing at day-start, giving players an immediate reason to care about that day's specific conditions before time pressure exists.

The **anxiety risk** sits in the final moments of the timer with quota still unmet — the compounding dread of running out of time while a friend might still be mid-bet. This is mitigated by the extra-life system: failing is a real penalty (wallet halved), but not instantly fatal, keeping the peak-tension moment high-stakes without becoming so punishing that players stop pushing their luck altogether.

5.4 Teaching Mechanics Through Level Sequencing

Mechanic to be taught	Where it is introduced	How the level teaches it
Press-your-luck betting (cash out vs. push)	Any table, first bet a player makes — naturally falls early on Day 1, when quota is still easy and the timer isn't a factor yet	Environmental cue: the minigame's own UI visually distinguishes "what you'd bank" from "what you're risking" through scale/color, so the choice is legible without text instructions

Mechanic to be taught	Where it is introduced	How the level teaches it
Hit-to-stun sabotage	Day 1, whenever any player's bet first climbs high enough to visibly shake/flash the shared wallet	Environmental cue + isolated safe space: the wallet's own reaction is what draws attention to the option to intervene, and because Day 1's quota is forgiving, a mistimed or unnecessary hit costs the team almost nothing — safe room to experiment with a mechanic that's riskier on later days
Carry (pick up / drop / throw)	Immediately following a player's first stun, same Day 1 moment	Environmental cue: a stunned player's ragdolled pose and a context prompt when another player walks into them makes the follow-up action discoverable without a tutorial popup
Exit convergence (end the day early)	End of Day 1, once quota is first met	Environmental cue: the door — already seen at spawn — visibly changes state (light, sound, or similar) once quota is hit, drawing players back to a space they already know rather than introducing a new location

VI. SYSTEMS AND BALANCE

6.1 Resource Economy

Resource	Source (how it enters play)	Sink (how it leaves play)	Starting value
Shared wallet	The House's one-time Day 1 loan; winnings cashed out at the five tables	Lost bets (bomb, failed crossing, losing hand or spin); every hit (0.5% of that day's quota, gone for good); halved when quota is first missed	1,000
Extra life	Granted once at the start of the run	Spent on the first missed quota; never regained	1
Time	A full 5:00 timer at the start of every day	Counts down in real time; leftover time is discarded if the day ends early at the exit zone	5:00 per day
Stunned state	Created when a hit lands on a standing player	Ends when the stunned player is dropped or thrown, never while carried	0 players stunned

6.2 Progression Curve

Day	Quota multiplier	Day-start wallet	Quota	Max bet
1	1.25	1,000	1,250	620
2	1.28	1,250	1,600	800
3	1.32	1,600	2,112	1,050
4	1.36	2,112	2,872	1,430
5	1.40	2,872	4,021	2,010
6	1.45	4,021	5,830	2,910
7	1.50	5,830	8,745	4,370
8	1.55	8,745	13,555	6,770
9	1.62	13,555	21,959	10,970
10	1.70	21,959	37,330	18,660

Fowl Play has no upgrades, unlocks, or shops (Section 4.4), so the team does not gain new abilities as the run goes on. Capability and challenge scale through the same two numbers: the quota multiplier and the max bet. All values here are provisional and will be tuned in LAN playtesting.

The run starts from a 1,000-coin wallet. Each day's quota is the day-start wallet multiplied by that day's multiplier, and the multiplier rises from 1.25 on Day 1 to 1.70 on Day 10, so the required gain climbs from +25% to +70% of the wallet the team walked in with. The max bet for any wager is half of that day's quota, rounded down to the nearest 10 and never more than the wallet, so betting power grows in step with the quota. The table shows a team that ends every day exactly at quota; a team that overshoots sees larger absolute numbers at the same relative challenge, because surplus raises the next quota.

Because the micro loop is identical on each every day (Section 4.3), difficulty is the size of the gap, not new mechanics. The tables pay generously at the stops players actually use, so the quota can be high. On Day 1, two or three well-chosen bets close the gap, which keeps the opening forgiving (Section 5.4). By Day 10, a single max bet is about 85% of the wallet and the gap is close to what one good crossing pays, so late days are decided by a few large bets, and one bust can put the day out of reach. A missed quota shows up as a visible spike in the curve: after the penalty, the wallet is halved but the next quota is still calculated from the wallet at the start of the failed day, so the team must gain roughly 150% to 240% of what it holds that day, more than double the normal gap.

6.3 Symmetry, Asymmetry, and Fairness

Fowl Play is a symmetric game with a rotating, temporary asymmetry on top. All four players have identical abilities and rules: the same movement, the same access to every table, and the same hit, stun, carry, and throw. No one has a class, a personal account, or an individual score, and the outcome is shared, so the team wins or loses together and no player can profit at a teammate's expense. Hitting is the clearest example: it is free and unrestricted, but every hit drains the shared wallet, so griefing a friend costs the griefer's own team, and a stunned player keeps camera control (Section 3.4) so they are never reduced to a bystander.

The only asymmetry is the Watched pair. Each day, one random player is Blessed and one is Cursed, each with one of three small effects that change a number (payout, loss, bet cap, or hit cost) and never remove a player's ability to act. The pair is announced at day start, so no advantage is hidden, and it is re-rolled daily with safeguards against the same player being Cursed twice in a row. A second, positional asymmetry is that only one player may occupy a table at a time, which turns who gets to gamble into a negotiation inside the group, not an unfair rule.

The outcome is meant to feel fair because the opposing system plays by rules the team can read. The House's pressure is the quota, shown on screen as wallet over quota. The tables pay above fair at the stops players actually use and below fair only deep in a push, so going too far is a visible choice with a visible price. Quota is calculated from the current wallet, so the challenge stays the same size whether the team is rich or poor. Some outcomes are harsh by design, such as a missed quota halving the wallet and widening the next day's gap, but that harshness applies identically to every team.

6.4 Randomness and Probability

System using randomness	Probability / range of values	Purpose of the randomness	Safeguard against unfair outcomes
Chicken Cross (lane busts)	Bust chance per lane (lanes 1-12): 7, 9, 11, 14, 17, 20, 24, 28, 32, 37, 42, 48%. Chance to reach lane 6: 43%; lane 12: 3%. Multipliers 1.3x to 15x	Makes every step a press-your-luck decision with a visible price for going on	Lanes 1-7 pay above fair (111-144% return) so sensible stops profit; lanes 8-12 pay below fair (46-89%) so greed costs; cash out after any lane; host rolls every step

System using randomness	Probability / range of values	Purpose of the randomness	Safeguard against unfair outcomes
Eggsweeper (bomb layout)	30 nests, 12 eggs, 18 bombs, layout random each round. Survival chance for 1-5 eggs: 40, 15, 5.4, 1.8, 0.6%. Multipliers 3x, 8.5x, 23x, 55x, 140x	Lets the picker's nerve decide how long to push; a bomb stuns the picker, which makes a bust visible and funny	Picks 1-3 pay above fair (120-129%), picks 4-5 pay at or below fair; auto cash-out at 5 eggs caps the payout at 140x; host places the bombs and clients never see them
Blackjack	One shuffled 52-card deck. Each undealt card is drawn uniformly from the remaining deck without replacement. Initial natural Blackjack occurs approximately 4.83% of the time. Card values are A = 1/11, 2–9 = face value, and 10/J/Q/K = 10. Dealer draw while below 17 and stand at 17 or higher.	Creates hand-by-hand uncertainty while still allowing the player to make meaningful Hit or Stand decisions based on the visible cards and their current hand value.	The host shuffles and deals all cards so clients cannot influence draws. Both player and dealer use the same deck and card rules. Dealer behavior is fixed and predictable. A normal win returns 2× the bet, a natural Blackjack returns 2.5× the bet, a tie returns the original bet, and the deck is reshuffled before a new round/deck cycle to prevent a depleted deck from creating unintended outcomes.

System using randomness	Probability / range of values	Purpose of the randomness	Safeguard against unfair outcomes
Roulette	Uniform random pocket per spin (37 pockets: 1-36 and 0). Each pocket has a probability of 1/37 ≈ 2.70%. Range: 0-36, with each number equally likely. Winning probability depends on the bet: straight-up (one number) = 1/37 (2.70%); red/black or odd/even = 18/37(48.65%); Zero(0) = 1/37(2.70%)	A fast, readable bet where the player picks the risk	**red/black** = 2x **odd/even** = 2x **straight up** = 35x + stakeback **Zero (0)** = 35x + stakeback Each pocket (0-36) has an equal 1/37 chance per spin. The host generates the result using a random number generator, bets lock during spins, and fixed payout rules ensure consistent winnings

System using randomness	Probability / range of values	Purpose of the randomness	Safeguard against unfair outcomes
Poker-flavored game	Shuffled deck, simplified hand strength 3 cards each for the player and The House; best to worst: straight flush, three of a kind, straight, flush, pair, high card; higher hand wins, exact ties are redealt; every decided hand is 50%, so 1 to 5 wins in a row is 50, 25, 12.5, 6.3, 3.1%	Reads and bluffing flavor without full Texas Hold'em	Payouts 2.2x, 4.6x, 9.5x, 16x, 28x follow the same rule as the other tables; host deals ; wins 1 to 3 pay above fair, win 4 pays fair, win 5 pays below fair; auto cash out at 5 wins
Watched assignment	Two of four players drawn each day, one Blessed and one Cursed (about 25% chance each per player per day); each side draws 1 of 3 effects (1 in 3 each)	Gives the group something new to read and argue about every day	Same player cannot be Cursed two days in a row; same effect cannot repeat on consecutive days; effects only change numbers; announced at day start
Daily minigame rotation	4 of the 5 minigames open each day, chosen at random	Keeps scouting at day start a small ritual and breaks fixed routines	Four tables are always open, matching the four players, so no one is locked out; every table is open about 80% of days

VII. NARRATIVE DESIGN

7.1 Premise and Setting

Fowl Play takes place entirely inside The House, a chicken-themed casino that exists as a single room and never closes. The player is one of four friends bound to a contract after eating wings from a "free wings-for-life" deal that only one of them signed. The fine print binds anyone who eats the wings, so all four now owe The House, and the contract can only be voided by winning enough money across 10 days. The House lends the group a one-time 1,000 coin loan on Day 1 and then watches. The narrative is deliberately minimal (Section 3.2): the premise explains why four friends gamble from one shared wallet, then gets out of the way of the social and physical systems.

7.2 Narrative Delivery Method

The story never stops the game. There are no cutscenes, dialogue trees, or text logs. It reaches the player through The House's announcer voice and through changes in the room itself, all of which already exist as part of the core loop. Three concrete examples of environmental storytelling:

1. The announcer voice. On Day 1, The House's voice reads the contract's key line as the day opens, then delivers every day-start announcement (quota, open tables, Watched players) in the same voice. The premise is repeated as routine, not as exposition.
2. The room's lighting and machines. When the extra life is spent, the lighting shifts to a harsher tone (Section 3.4). At Game Over, the lights cut, the machines go dark, and The House delivers a closing line. The player reads how close they are to losing from the room, without a menu telling them.
3. The exit door. The door is visible from spawn and changes state (light, sound) once quota is met (Section 5.4). In the fiction, it is the contract's release valve. Leaving is earned, and it only works if all connected players walk through it together.

7.3 Branching and Player Agency

The narrative is linear: Day 1 through Day 10, ending in either a win (quota met on Day 10) or Game Over (second missed quota). A branching story would need extra writing, dialogue, and endings, and Section 1.4 already cuts the hidden alt-ending, so the team spent its hours on the Fellowship, Challenge, and Sensation systems instead (Section 3.2).

Player agency lives in the one decision the game repeats at every table: cash out or push. Cashing out gives up the bigger payout and the faster route to quota. Pushing gives up the bet already on the table and, because the wallet is shared, puts teammates' money at risk too. Each day also forces a second decision, whether to hit a friend or let the bet ride, which gives up either wallet money (every hit drains the shared wallet) or the chance of a bust being stopped.

Linear flow for the diagram:
Day 1 (contract line) → Days 2–9 → Day 10 → Win,
with a missed quota branching to the extra-life penalty and a second miss to Game Over.

VIII. TECHNICAL DESIGN

8.1 2D, 3D, or Hybrid Decision

Fowl Play is a 3D game built around first-person cameras. Readability: the core tension depends on players noticing a teammate's bet from across the room and on being physically able to hit, grab, and carry each other, so a grounded 3D space with real distance and sightlines serves the loop better than a flat view (Sections 1.3 and 5.1). Scope: the game is one open room with low-poly props, five table interactions, and a scripted limp-pose stun instead of ragdoll physics, so the 3D workload stays small (Section 1.4). Team skill: [CONFIRM: describe the team's experience with Godot 4 3D, CharacterBody3D movement, and LAN multiplayer]. To keep the 3D scope matched to that skill level, characters are simple primitives with no detailed animation, and the physics sync is host-authoritative with basic interpolation.

8.2 Camera System

Camera type	First-person Camera3D, one per player, attached to the player's Head node and controlled by mouse look. Each client activates only its own camera. Field of view starts at 75 degrees (provisional, to be tuned in LAN playtesting).
What the camera must always keep visible	What the camera must always keep visible | The HUD overlay with wallet versus quota, the 5:00 timer, the current day, extra-life status, and the Watched banner. When seated, the table's cash-out-or-push state and the bet versus the amount banked. In the room, teammates, the other tables, and the exit door's state.

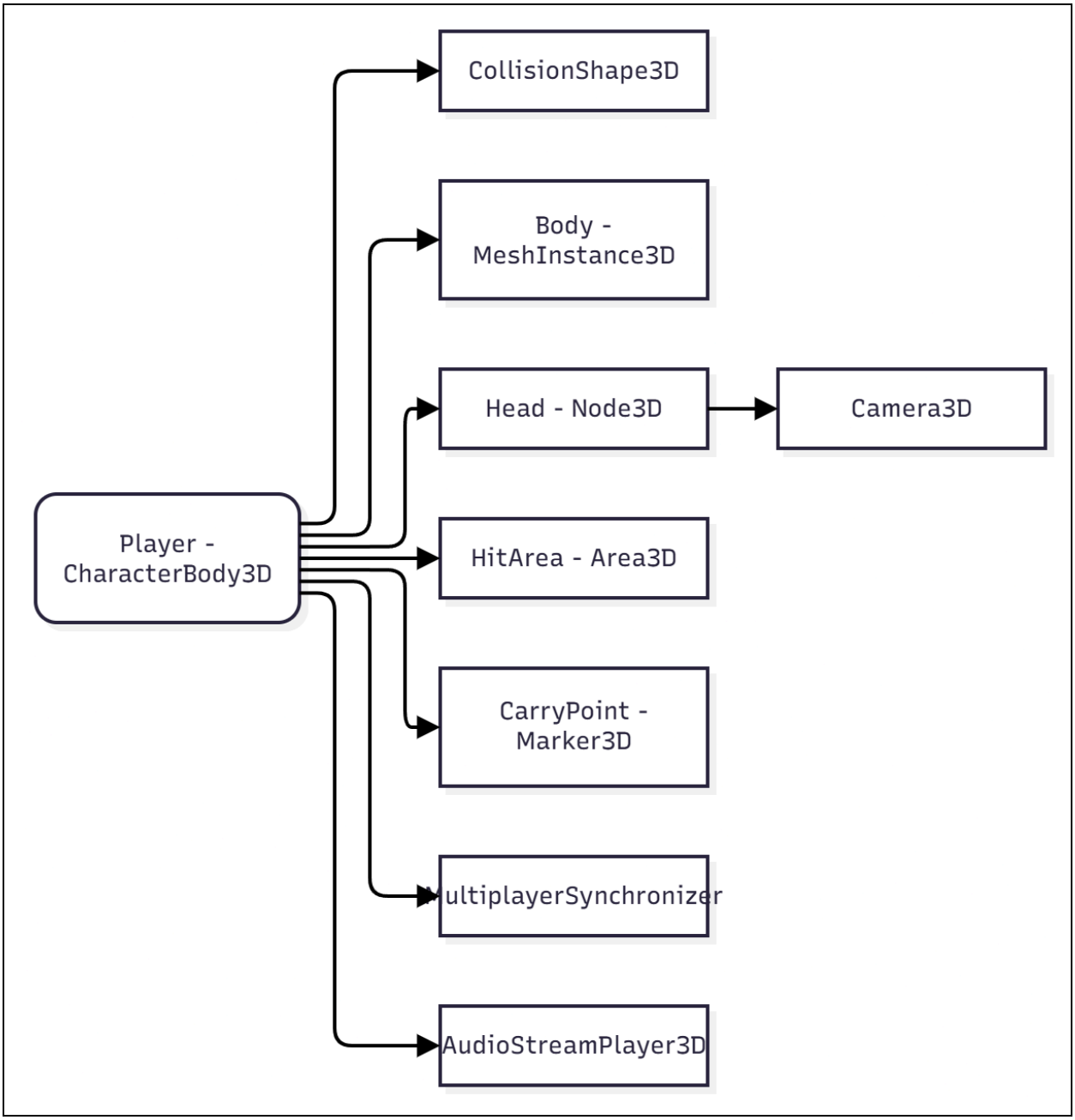
Readability risks	(1) Teammates outside the field of view while a bet escalates: mitigated by the wallet shake/flash, the escalating audio cue tied to bet size, directional 3D audio for hits, and the open layout. (2) Stunned or carried view pointing at the floor or the carrier's back: the carried player keeps look control (Section 3.4), with the camera anchored to the carry point and pitch clamped so they can still see the room and react. (3) Tunnel vision while seated: table UI sits in the lower centre of the screen, the player can still look around, and the wallet HUD stays on screen. (4) Discomfort from knockback or throws: any camera shake is brief, with no roll.

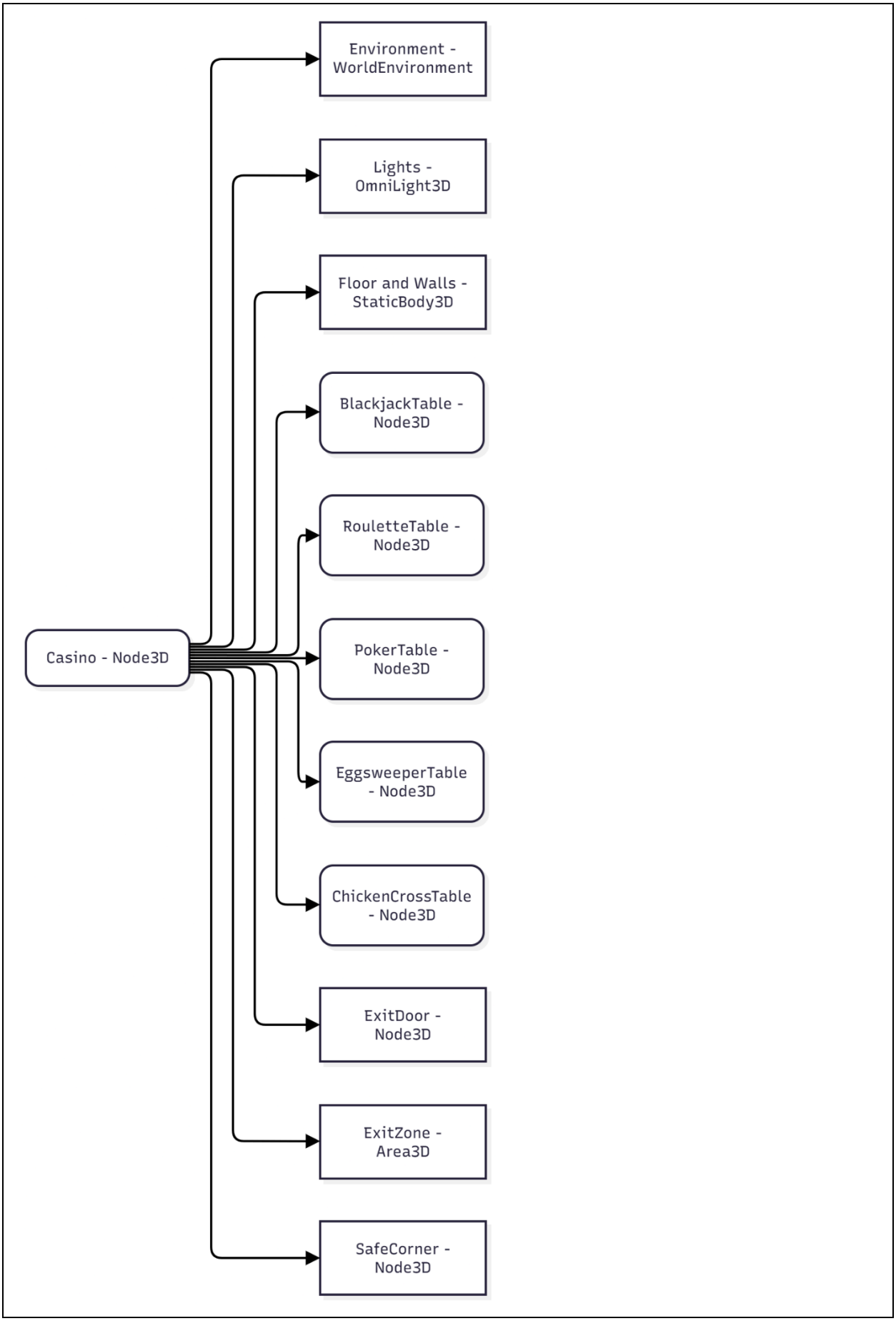
8.3 Control Scheme and Input Mapping

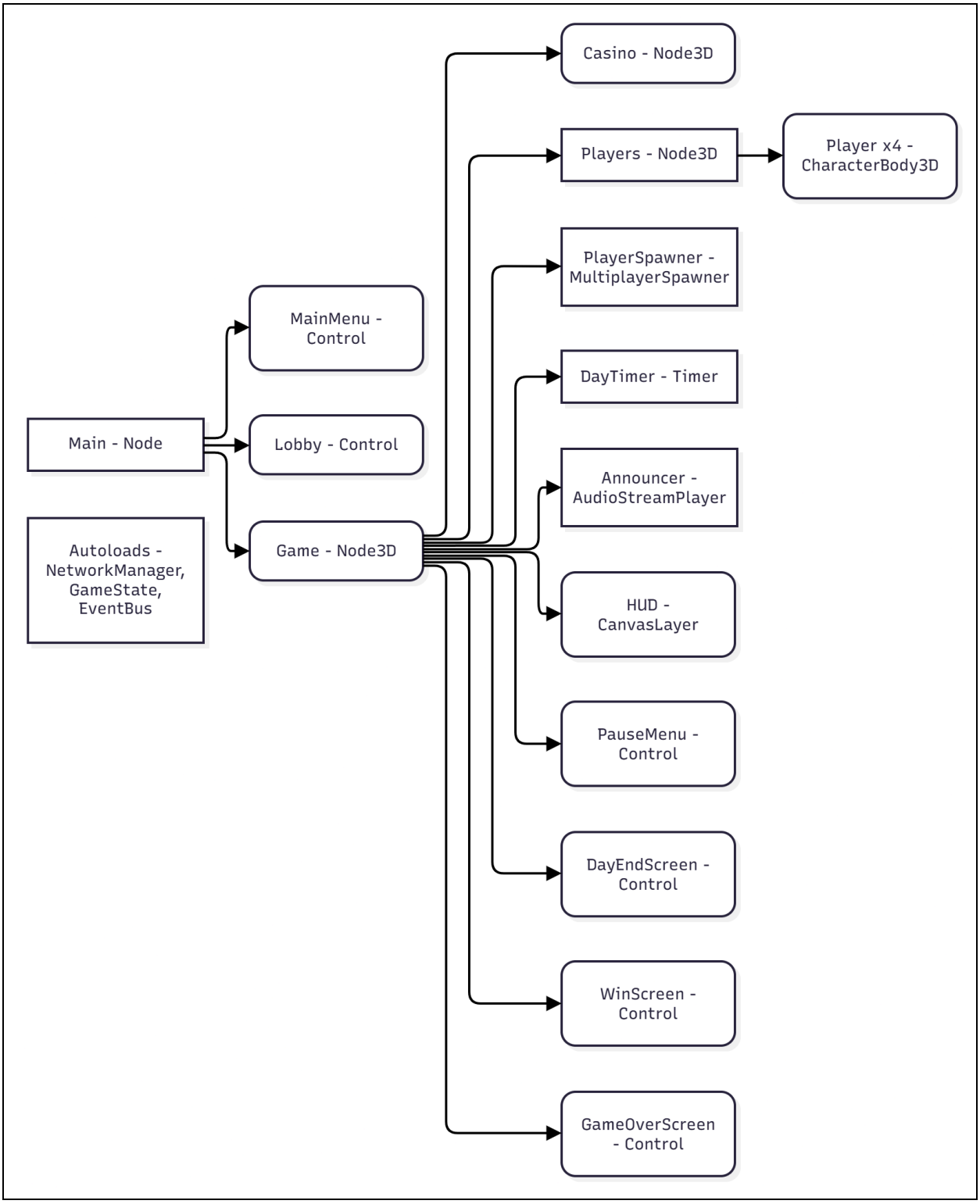
Player action	Primary input	Alternate input	Rationale
Move (move_forward, move_back, move_left, move_right)	W S A D	↑ arrow_key ↓ arrow_key ← arrow_key → arrow_key	Standard first-person layout; alternate supports players used to arrow keys.
Look (look_left, look_right, look_up, look_down)	Mouse movement (Mouse)	I K J L	Mouse is the genre standard; keyboard alternate allows play if the mouse is unavailable.
sit at or leave a table, pick up a stunned teammate (interact)	E	F	One context-sensitive key keeps the control count low.
Hit (hit)	Left mouse button (M1)	Q	Hit is spammable, so it sits on the easiest input.

Player action	Primary input	Alternate input	Rationale
Throw (throw)	Right mouse button (M2) while carrying	G	Separate from Drop so dragging and throwing are distinct choices.
Push, at a table (push)	Space	Left mouse button	One quick key for the press-your-luck choice.
Cash out, at a table (cash_out)	C	Right mouse button	Kept physically apart from Push to reduce accidental cash-outs.
Select table option, such as a nest, lane, or bet (select_option)	Mouse aim and left click (M1)	↑ arrow_key ↓ arrow_key ← arrow_key → arrow_key and ↵ Enter	Works across all five tables.
Pause (pause)	Esc	P	Standard; needed for the pause screen the rubric expects.

8.4 Godot Scene Tree Plan


CollisionShape3D
Body - MeshInstance3D
Head - Node3D
Camera3D
Player - CharacterBody3D
HitArea - Area3D
CarryPoint - Marker3D
ultiplayerSynchronizer
AudioStreamPlayer3D


Casino - Node3D
Environment - WorldEnvironment
Lights - OmniLight3D
Floor and Walls - StaticBody3D
BlackjackTable - Node3D
RouletteTable - Node3D
PokerTable - Node3D
EggsweeperTable - Node3D
ChickenCrossTable - Node3D
ExitDoor - Node3D
ExitZone - Area3D
SafeCorner - Node3D


Casino - Node3D
Players - Node3D
Player x4 - CharacterBody3D
PlayerSpawner - MultiplayerSpawner
MainMenu - Control
DayTimer - Timer
Main - Node
Lobby - Control
Announcer - AudioStreamPlayer
Autoloads - NetworkManager, GameState, EventBus
Game - Node3D
HUD - CanvasLayer
PauseMenu - Control
DayEndScreen - Control
WinScreen - Control
GameOverScreen - Control

8.5 Signals and Event Wiring

Signal	Emitted by	Connected to	What happens as a result
bet_placed (player_id, table_id, amount)	Table	GameState	Host checks the amount against the max bet and wallet, then deducts it.
bet_resolved (table_id, payout)	Table	GameState	Winnings go to the wallet; a lost bet is simply gone.
wallet_changed (balance)	GameState	HUD, audio	HUD updates with shake or flash, and the bet-size audio cue plays.
player_hit (target_id, attacker_id)	Player (HitArea)	GameState	Hit cost of 0.5% of quota leaves the wallet, and the target is stunned.
player_stunned (player_id)	Player	HUD, audio	Limp pose, impact sound, and slow-down.
player_picked_up , player_dropped, player_thrown	Player	Target Player	Carry-lock starts or ends; a drop or throw wakes the stunned player.
watched_assigned (blessed_id, cursed_id)	GameState	HUD	Day-start banner shows Blessed and Cursed, and their effects apply.
day_started (day, quota, open_tables)	GameState	HUD, Casino, Announcer	Quota and open tables appear, closed tables go dark, and The House speaks.
time_expired	DayTimer	GameState	Quota check runs.

Signal	Emitted by	Connected to	What happens as a result
quota_met	GameState	ExitDoor, HUD	Door changes state and the HUD shows quota reached.
exit_zone_filled	ExitZone	GameState	If quota is met and all connected players are inside, the day ends early.
day_ended (quota_met)	GameState	DayEndScreen	Success moves to the next day; a miss triggers the extra-life penalty.
extra_life_spent	GameState	HUD, lights, Announcer	Wallet resets to half of its day-start balance, lighting shifts, and the penalty cue plays.
run_won	GameState	WinScreen	Day 10 quota is met.
game_over	GameState	GameOverScreen, lights	A second missed quota ends the run: lights cut, machines go dark, and The House gives a closing line.